

문과 건물 안 표지판 읽기: 미세요? 당기세요?

Ten short signs you see on doors and inside Korean buildings: push, pull, entrance, exit, emergency exit, restroom, in use, out of order, no entry and no smoking. For each one, you learn what it means and what to do.

WHAT THIS IS FOR



Read 10 common door and building signs (미세요, 당기세요, 입구, 출구, 비상구, 화장실, 사용 중, 고장, 출입 금지, 금연) and choose or say the right action for each one.

1 ON THE DOOR: PUSH OR PULL?

미세요 (miseyo) = Push. It comes from 밀다 (to push). The ㄹ drops before -세요, so you see 미세요, not 밀세요.

당기세요 (danggiseyo) = Pull. It comes from 당기다 (to pull).

Both signs are polite requests to you, the person at the door. To say what you do, use 밀어요 (I push) and 당겨요 (I pull).

예: 이 문은 무거워요. 세게 밀어요. (This door is heavy. I push it hard.)

2 GOING IN AND OUT

입구 (ipgu, said [입꾸]) = entrance, the way in. 입 means 'enter'.

출구 (chulgu) = exit, the way out. 출 means 'go out'.

비상구 (bisanggu) = emergency exit. Use it in a fire or another emergency.

예: 지하철 출구가 어디예요? (Where is the subway exit?)

3 ROOMS AND MACHINES

화장실 (hwajangsil) = restroom. This sign only tells you where the restroom is.

사용 중 (sayong jung) = in use or occupied. Someone is using it now, so wait.

고장 (gojang) = out of order or broken. Do not use it. People also say 고장 났어요 (It broke down).

예: 엘리베이터가 고장이예요. 계단으로 가요. (The elevator is out of order. Let's take the stairs.)

4 SIGNS THAT SAY 'DON'T'

출입 금지 (churip geumji, said [추립 금지]) = no entry. 출입 means 'going in and out', and 금지 means 'forbidden'. Do not go through this door.



금연 (geumyeon, said [그면]) = no smoking. 금 means 'forbid', and 연 means 'smoke'.

예: 여기는 금연이에요. 밖에서 피우세요. (This is a no-smoking area. Please smoke outside.)

Tip: 입구, 출구 and 출입 all use 입 (in) and 출 (out). If you learn these two parts, you can often guess new signs.

5 YOUR TURN



READ THE SIGNS AND ACT

Use the sign meanings in this worksheet to match, choose or fill in the right answer for each item.

1

Write the sign from the box that matches each meaning (미세요, 당기세요, 입구, 출구, 비상구): way in / pull / emergency exit / push / way out

2

Write the sign from the box that matches each meaning (화장실, 사용 중, 고장, 출입 금지, 금연): no smoking / out of order / restroom / no entry / in use

3

Does the sign say something is broken or in use? Write Broken, In use or Neither for each sign: 고장 / 사용 중 / 화장실 / 비상구

4

Is it OK to do this? Write Yes or No: You smoke under a 금연 sign. / You walk through a door marked 출입 금지. / You leave the building through the door marked 출구. / During a fire, you run to the door marked 비상구.

5

Fill in the blank with 밀어요 or 당겨요: 카페 문에 '당기세요'가 있어요. 그래서 문을 ____.

6

Fill in the blank with 밀어요 or 당겨요: 약국 문에 '미세요'가 있어요. 그래서 문을 ____.



ANSWERS

- 1) 입구 / 당기세요 / 비상구 / 미세요 / 출구
- 2) 금연 / 고장 / 화장실 / 출입 금지 / 사용 중
- 3) Broken / In use / Neither / Neither

- 4) No / No / Yes / Yes
- 5) 당겨요
- 6) 밀어요

